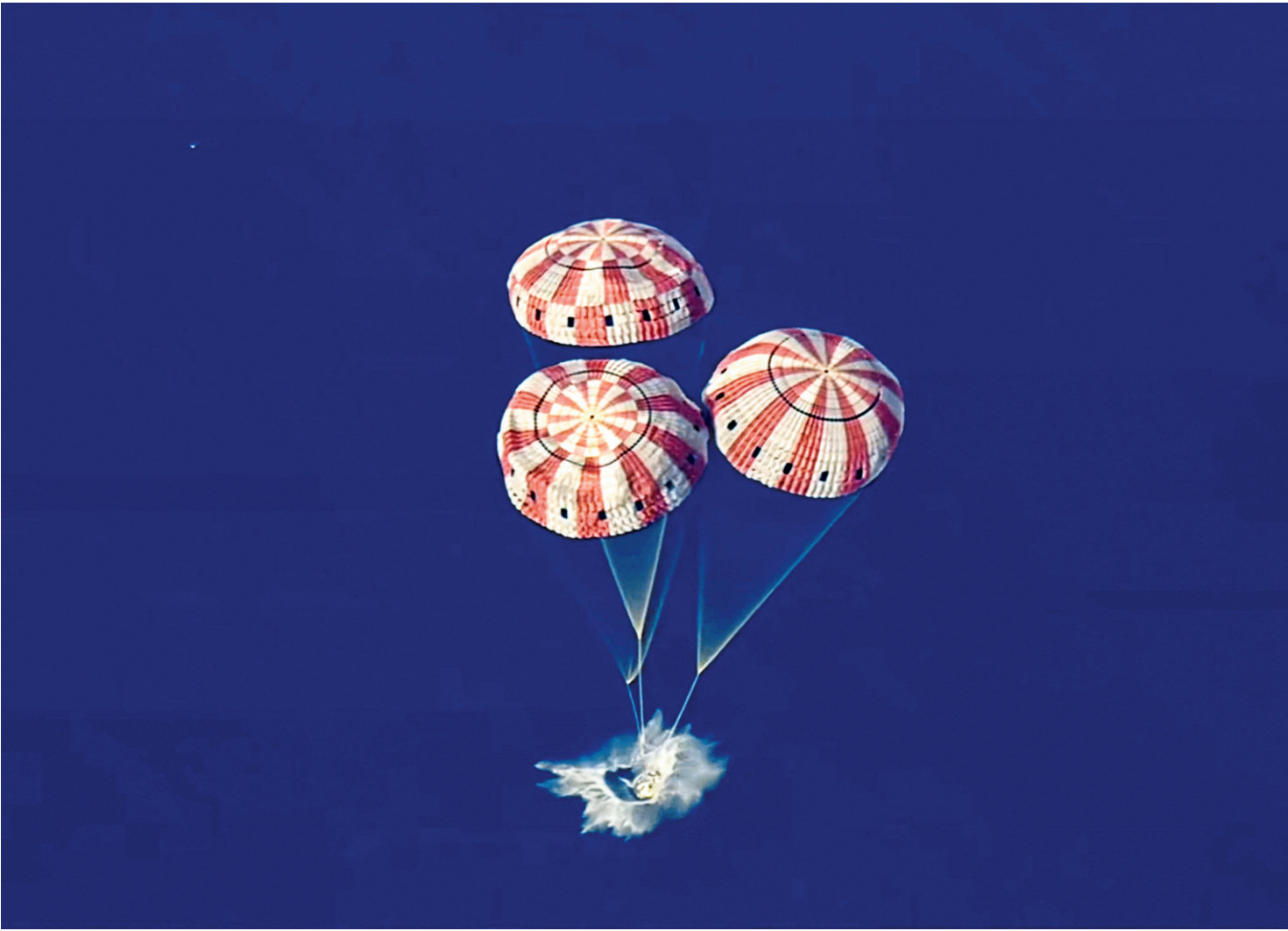




NASA/HANDOUT, VIA REUTERS

Back Home After a Lunar Loop
The Artemis II capsule splashed down on Friday, after taking humans farther from Earth than ever before. Coverage at nytimes.com.

100 Days In, Mamdani Is Learning as He Goes

By **DANA RUBINSTEIN** and **SALLY GOLDENBERG**

On Palm Sunday, in the heart of Black, middle-class Queens, Mayor Zohran Mamdani preached the gospel of homeownership to “people that are so often being pushed out.”

What seemed like a throwaway line in a longer address may actually have carried a far more conciliatory purpose. The mayor had angered many Black homeowners by proposing to raise property taxes, and amid the ensuing uproar, Mr. Mamdani all but abandoned the idea.

His speech, at a Black church, seemed designed to make amends with an important, and still largely supportive, voting bloc.

The moment captured an important element of Mr. Mamdani’s rapid evolution from inexperienced state lawmaker to manager of the nation’s largest city. By necessity, he was learning on the job.

One hundred days into his mayoralty, Mr. Mamdani has hustled up a litany of quick accomplishments. He has reignited projects to improve bus speeds; built a City Hall rest stop for delivery workers; opened a long-delayed new infirmary for Rikers Island detainees; secured state money to fund an incremental expansion of free preschool; and wielded the powers of his office to go after both abusive employers and bad landlords.

But he has also quickly retreated from one campaign promise after another. He once vowed to relinquish unilateral control of public schools in a nod to the teachers’ union; now he supports renewing the law that established it. He had pledged to expand a rental voucher program; now he is trying to limit its growth. Where once he called for reducing class sizes, now he is asking for more time to implement the costly mandate.

The mayor has made no dis-

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JUAN ARREDONDO FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Mayor Zohran Mamdani helped the Department of Sanitation on Friday, his 100th day in office.

Travelers Open Their Wallets for Plusher Flights

By **NIRAJ CHOKSHI**

Twenty years ago, Delta Air Lines was giving away its best seats.

Back then, only about 15 percent of first-class passengers paid for their seats, while most of the rest were loyal customers the airline had upgraded for free. Delta has since flipped the script: Today, it sells over 70 percent of those prime seats, a shift that has helped it become the most profitable airline in the United States.

“When you think about where the industry was 20 years ago, or where Delta was, we basically just sold main cabin seats,” said Joe Esposito, Delta’s chief commercial officer. He added, “What we all thought back then was, ‘Can you make a premium product that people are willing to pay for?’”

The answer has been a resounding yes. Airlines have become much better at selling those nice seats to travelers, and customers have grown much more willing to pay for them.

The biggest U.S. carriers — American Airlines, Delta and United Airlines — have invested billions of dollars to redesign planes with more cushy seats and

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Starmer Embraces Other Allies
Britain’s leader is strengthening ties in Europe and the Middle East as the once-special relationship with America sours. News Analysis. PAGE A9

Endangered By Warming
Populations of emperor penguins are declining as climate change causes the sea ice they need for survival to retreat, according to researchers. PAGE A4



NATIONAL A13-19

An ICE Plan Draws Pushback
Residents of a Republican stronghold in central Pennsylvania worry that a mega immigrant detention center would strain resources. PAGE A13

Redefining ‘America First’
President Trump, and his allies and critics on the right, race to redefine foreign policy amid a new war. PAGE A15

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A Bogey Golfer Tries Augusta
The secrets to making the best of a rare opportunity? Don’t be a hero. Have a plan — and a great caddy. PAGE B6



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‘Godfather of Hip-Hop’
Afrika Bambaataa, a pioneering rapper and D.J. from the Bronx, was accused of child sexual abuse later in his career. He was 67. PAGE A21

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Betty Buckley PAGE A23

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Matisse in a Rare Spotlight
The Acquavella Galleries in Manhattan offers more than 50 works, many from private collections, amid a surge of shows on the great painter. PAGE C1

BUSINESS B1-5

Trade Fraud Is Proliferating
U.S. imports from China have shrunk. But gimmicks may be the reason for billions of dollars of the change. PAGE B1

Pressure on Economy’s Engine
Consumer spending is being tamped down by higher fuel costs that are raising food and travel prices. PAGE B1

THE MAGAZINE



THIS WEEKEND

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Chance for U.S.-Iran Deal Uncertain Ahead of Talks

Tehran Adds to List of Demands as Vance Heads to Negotiations in Pakistan

This article is by **Yeganeh Torbati, Adam Rasgon, Euan Ward and Michael Levenson**.

Vice President JD Vance traveled to Pakistan on Friday for peace talks with Iran, even as Israeli strikes against Hezbollah in Lebanon and uncertainty over the Strait of Hormuz raised questions about the durability of the cease-fire and whether the United States and Iran could reach a long-term deal.

Mr. Vance said he believed the negotiations were “going to be positive,” but he also had a warning for Iran.

“If the Iranians are willing to negotiate in good faith, we’re certainly willing to extend the open hand,” he said before departing for Islamabad, the Pakistani capital. “If they’re going to try to play us, then they’re going to find that the negotiating team is not that receptive.”

The speaker of the Iranian Parliament, Mohammad Bagher Ghalibaf, on Friday reiterated Iran’s position that negotiations with the United States could not start until there is a cease-fire in Lebanon. Mr. Ghalibaf also introduced what appeared to be a new demand for frozen Iranian assets to be released.

“Two of the measures mutually agreed upon between the parties have yet to be implemented: a ceasefire in Lebanon and the release of Iran’s blocked assets prior to the commencement of negotiations,” Mr. Ghalibaf wrote on social media. “These two matters must be fulfilled before negotiations begin.”

Later, the Iranian delegation, led by Mr. Ghalibaf and Abbas Araghchi, the Iranian foreign minister, arrived in Islamabad to participate in the talks, Pakistan’s Foreign Ministry said.

President Trump wrote on social media that Iran was overplaying its hand in advance of the talks. “The Iranians don’t seem to realize they have no cards, other than a short term extortion of the World by using International Waterways,” he wrote on Truth Social, referring to Iran’s control of

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U.S. URGES ALLIES TO FIGHT FAR LEFT

Affixing Terrorism Label to Array of Activism

This article is by **Jack Nicas, Alan Feuer, Matina Stevis-Gridneff, Edward Wong and Jim Tankersley**.

WASHINGTON — When senior Western officials met in Ottawa last month to discuss potential terrorism threats in light of the U.S.-Israeli war against Iran, a top State Department counterterrorism official delivered an unexpected message.

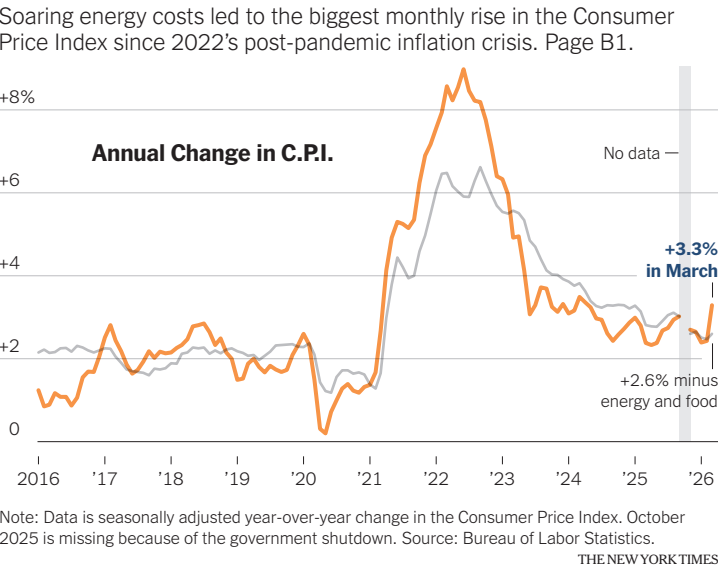
The United States was as concerned as always about Islamist terrorism, said the official, Monica A. Jacobsen, according to a copy of her prepared remarks reviewed by The New York Times and three officials briefed on the meeting. But, she told her counterparts from Europe, Canada and Australia, the Trump administration also wanted more attention on what it believed was an insidious, underestimated threat: the far left.

Western governments must combat “antifa and far-left terrorism,” Ms. Jacobsen’s prepared remarks asserted, casting the effort as an evolution in counterterrorism following the “global war on terror.” Her prepared speech defined far-left terrorism to include threats from communists, Marxists, anarchists, anticapitalists and those with “eco-extremist” and “other self-identified antifascist ideologies.”

“It is important to recognize their actions as political terrorism rather than mere protest or criminality,” she said.

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U.S. Inflation Surged in March



Encouraging Russians to Bond With Comrades in North Korea

By **VALERIE HOPKINS**

MOSCOW — Anastasia Rusanova started learning Korean when she was 13, drawn to K-pop and the television dramas that helped make South Korea a cultural powerhouse. Now studying at a university in Moscow, she hopes to turn her hobby into a career.

But in a turn reflecting the drastic change in Russia’s global relations since its invasion of Ukraine in 2022, Ms. Rusanova now thinks her professional future might be tied to North Korea rather than its southern neighbor.

“Our country is improving relations with North Korea,” Ms. Rusanova, 21, said in an interview shortly after returning from the East Asian country as part of an exchange program. “And for me, as far as career advancement in Russia goes, North Korea seems more promising.”

North Korea, a totalitarian state most associated with famines, human rights abuses and nuclear threats, has an economy one-fifth the size of South Korea’s. But the Russian government sees much to like, and it has been working to promote warm feelings for North Korea among the Russian people.

As the war in Ukraine has intensified, the Kremlin has been encouraging Russians to bond with comrades in North Korea as part of an

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Avid Video Gamer? The F.A.A. Has a Job Offer.

By **KAROUN DEMIRJIAN**

WASHINGTON — As the Trump administration seeks to fill a national shortage of air traffic controllers, officials are targeting a new talent pool: gamers.

The Federal Aviation Administration on Friday is making a recruiting push aimed at avid players of video games, as the agency strives to fill thousands of vacancies that lawmakers have said leave the traveling public less

A Skill Set Pairs Well to Air Traffic Control

safe. In a new YouTube ad, the agency is using flashy graphics and the promise of six-figure salaries to persuade video game enthusiasts to apply their trigger fingers in service of air safety.

In recent years, video gamers have emerged as a target demographic for recruiters at a number of federal agencies, including the military and the Department of Homeland Security. They are welcomed for their hand-eye coordination, quick decision-making in complex environments and ability to remain focused on screens for hours on end.

“To reach the next generation of air traffic controllers, we need to adapt,” Transportation Secretary Sean Duffy said in a statement.

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